

Lab 02 — Your First Live Artefact

Topic 01 · Claude Cowork Fundamentals

Meridian Capital Partners Pte Ltd — all data in this lab is synthetic and for training only.

Goal

Now you have seen Cowork do a real piece of work, meet the other thing it makes: a Live Artefact. You build a small tool rather than ask a question, so you can see how an artefact differs from a chat answer — it persists, it is interactive, and you can save and download it. You also meet the sandbox: an artefact cannot call the internet, so you build one version with the rates baked in and a downloadable HTML version that fetches them live.

You'll build

An FX converter as a saved artefact, plus a downloadable HTML version with live rates.

Tools: Claude desktop app, Claude Cowork, Live Artefacts

The prompt

Copy this into Claude (it is also in PROMPT.md):

PROMPT — copy into Claude

I want a currency converter for Meridian Capital Partners, in three steps. Artefacts cannot call the internet, so do NOT put any fetch, API call or network request in the artefact — it will fail.

STEP 1 — You look up the rates.

Search the web for today's mid-market rates from SGD to USD, EUR and GBP. Tell me the three rates and the date, in the chat.

STEP 2 — Build the artefact with those numbers HARD-CODED.

Write the three rates into the code as constants. No fetch anywhere.

- Convert between SGD, USD, EUR and GBP.
- One amount box, a from-currency and a to-currency selector, and a large result that updates as I type.
- Under the result show the rate used, and the line "Rates as at <the date from Step 1> — fixed at build time".
- Clean, professional finance styling, titled "Meridian Capital Partners".

STEP 3 — Now a SEPARATE downloadable HTML file.

Save a file called meridian-fx-live.html to my folder. Same design, but this one DOES fetch rates from a free no-key API (such as open.er-api.com or frankfurter.app) when it opens, with a Refresh button and the fetch time shown. Tell me where you saved it.

Do not show this version as an artefact — it only works when I open the file in my own browser.

Note: The prompt tells Claude NOT to put a fetch in the artefact. If you leave that out, Claude writes one and the artefact shows "Live rate lookup failed" — the sandbox blocks it. Live data belongs in the downloadable HTML, which runs in your own browser.

Steps

1. Start a new Cowork session — this lab needs no files.

Lab 1 gave Claude a folder to work in; here you are asking it to build something from nothing.

2. Paste the lab prompt into the composer and send it.

It asks for three things in order: look up the rates, build the artefact, then save a separate live HTML file.

3. Read the three rates Claude reports back in the chat.

Claude can search the web; the artefact cannot. This is why the lookup happens here, in the conversation, and not inside the tool.

4. Try the artefact: change the amount and switch the currencies.

It works instantly because the rates are constants in the code — no network call to fail.

5. Check the artefact's rate against a search for "1 USD to SGD".

It should match today, because Claude looked it up minutes ago. The "fixed at build time" line is the honest caveat.

6. Open the downloaded meridian-fx-live.html in your browser and click Refresh.

Same design, but running outside the sandbox, so THIS one really does fetch live rates. That contrast is the lesson.

7. Ask for one refinement in plain English, for example: Add a thousands separator to the result.

Refining by conversation is the normal way to work — you never edit the code yourself.

8. Save the artefact so it appears in your sidebar.

A saved artefact persists as a reusable tool; an unsaved one scrolls away with the chat.

Check your work

The artefact converts S\$10,000 to USD with no error, shows the rate used and a "Rates as at ... — fixed at build time" line, and the rate matches a live search. Separately, meridian-fx-live.html opens in your browser, fetches its own rates and updates them when you click Refresh. The artefact is saved in your sidebar.

Further viewing

- CLAUDE COWORK FULL COURSE 3 HOURS For Beginners (2026)

Optional background, not needed to complete the lab.

Before you move on

Use only the supplied mock data and your own test accounts. Never put real client, personal or confidential data into a training exercise, and send lab emails to yourself rather than to a real recipient.